responses nonetheless revolved around Islam as the defining feature of being a Pakistani citizen (see Nelson 2008; Dean 2005; Rahman 2004).

The Islamic Republic of Pakistan

What is the meaning of Pakistan? 'There is no God but Allah' is a predominant theme that emerged in this research, consistent with other studies (Afzal 2015; Dean 2005). This belief is not only promoted through the curriculum as the preceding section has highlighted, but also common in the unwritten curriculum of Pakistan, one that is repeatedly heard in public rallies organized by political figures, one that is chanted at the Wagha border during the popular 'Beating Retreat ceremony' when India and Pakistan lower their flags with the Pakistan side chanting 'What is the meaning of Pakistan? La illaha illAllah'[9]. The belief that Pakistan is an Islamic Republic is repeatedly engrained in the social psyche of Pakistanis, one that often fails to take into account the identity of non-Muslim Pakistanis, or those declared non-Muslim by the state. Simon (2013) in his exploration of citizenship highlights the danger of 'tying' 'citizenship to any kind of identity' as it is 'then tied to a particular conception of national identity, which, by its very nature precludes other conceptions of group entity' (p. 511), which in the case of Pakistan are non-Muslims, or those deemed non-Muslim by the state, hence occupying a different status of citizenship. '*Pak logoon kai rehnei ki jagha – Land of purity*' (Student, Female, Lahore); '*Our values, identity, flag, ideology and religion make us Pakistani*' (Teacher, Female, Hub2); '*Islamic Democratic state, who worships One Allah Almighty*' (Student, Female, Lahore). This belief in the Islamic purity of Pakistan is one that has been echoed by not just students in school, but by their teachers, and by adults studying in universities. The first quote for instance is by an academic who teaches at a university in Lahore, the second by a teacher who teaches in a government school in Hub, while the third is an undergraduate student of humanities in another university in Lahore. These adults are a product of an education and social system that reinforces this belief.

The problem with basing citizenship on Islam is that it removes any possibility of debate. However, there were exceptions to the narrative, albeit in a minority. At a private university in Karachi where a majority of the students were from private schools, where as undergraduate students they had been exposed to an alternative history of Pakistan, participants were questioning the reason behind Pakistan's creation, and the role of Islam in Pakistan:

> *As far as Pakistan was concerned Jinnah's demand was both tactical and practical given the circumstances. Until 1946 he was not expecting a separate nation. He thought when the British would leave the Muslims would have*